

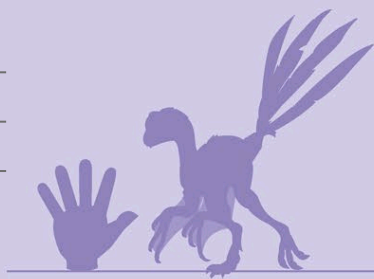
FLASHY FEATHERS

EPIDEXIPTERYX

The tiny *Epidexipteryx* clambered around the Jurassic forests of what is now **China** on the hunt for its next meal. Its features and small frame were very different from those of a typical theropod. Its teeth, located at the front of its jaws, were angled forward, and it had long tail feathers. What *Epidexipteryx* ate is still unknown, but its small size and pointy teeth lead paleontologists to believe that it probably preyed mainly on insects.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 10 in (26 cm), excluding tail feathers
- **DIET** Insectivore
- **LIVED** 165–161 MYA
- **HABITAT** Forests close to lakes and trees



Fuzzlike feathers covered much of *Epidexipteryx*'s body.

Long, ornamental feathers jutted out from *Epidexipteryx*'s back.

Epidexipteryx's arms and elongated fingers might have supported a batlike wing membrane.

